

IOWA STATE UNIVERSITY

Master of Professional Practice in Dietetics

RDN Track

Program Handbook



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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Abbreviations Used in This Handbook.....	4
SECTION I: INTRODUCTION.....	5
Welcome	5
Program Description	5
Program Mission	5
SECTION II: MPPD POLICIES AND PROCEDURES	6
A. Admission Related Policies.....	6
Program Eligibility	6
Admission Requirements	6
B. Application Procedures	7
C. Policies Post Acceptance to the MPPD	7
Program Orientation	7
Registration for Classes	7
Protection of Privacy of Student Information	8
Student Access to Their Own Student Files	8
Access to Student Support Services	8
Monitoring Student Performance	8
Regular Reports of Student Performance and Progress	8
Program Retention and Remediation Procedures	9
Disciplinary/Termination Procedures	9
Withdrawal and Refund of Tuition and Fees	10
Graduation and/or Program Completion Requirements	10
D. Academic and Program Calendar	11
Program schedule and holidays	11
MPPD program timeline	11
E. Tuition, Fees, and Program Expenses	12
Program Related Expenses	12
SECTION III: IOWA STATE UNIVERSITY POLICIES AND RESOURCES	14
Iowa State University Resources	14
Dean of Students Office	14
Iowa State Online	14
The Office of the Registrar	14
Office of International Students and Scholars	14
Student Counseling Services	14
Thielen Student Health Center	14
Office of Financial Aid	14
Academic Success Center	14
University Library	14
Iowa State University Policies	14
Nondiscrimination Policy	14
Student Privacy and Record Information	14
Name and Sex Marker Change Policies	15
Special Accommodations	15

Graduate College Resources	15
Academic Plan and Other Graduate College Deadlines	15
Grades	15
Withdrawal	16
<i>SECTION IV: APPENDICES</i>	<i>17</i>
1. Master of Professional Practice in Dietetics Course Schedule.....	18
2. Course Completion Plan.....	20
3. Code of Ethics for the Nutrition and Dietetics Profession.....	22
4. Consent to Use Work	26

Abbreviations Used in This Handbook

Academy	Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics
CDR	Commission on Dietetic Registration
DI	Dietetic Internship
DOGE	Director of Graduate Education
FERPA	Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act
FMLA	Family and Medical Leave Act
ISU	Iowa State University
MPP	Master of Professional Practice in Dietetics
NCM	Nutrition Care Manual
NCP	Nutrition Care Process
eNCPT	Electronic Nutrition Care Process Terminology
NDTR	Nutrition and Dietetics Technician, Registered
PES	Problem, Etiology, Signs/Symptoms
POS	Program of Study
POSC	Program of Study and Committee
RDN	Registered Dietitian Nutritionist

SECTION I: INTRODUCTION

Welcome

Welcome to the Iowa State University (ISU) and the **Master of Professional Practice in Dietetics** (MPPD) program. The MPPD is housed in the [Department of Food Science and Human Nutrition](#), which is jointly administered by the [College of Health and Human Sciences](#) and the [College of Agriculture and Life Sciences](#). The faculty and staff of the MPPD are committed to your success and are looking forward to assisting you to achieve your educational and career goals. This program handbook provides you with information you will use throughout the program, including program policies and university resources.

Program Description

The MPPD is an online graduate degree program, requiring completion of a minimum of 30 credits, where you will get credit for your education and work experience. Schedule of classes can be found in **Appendix 1**. Classes are only offered once a year and the time frame for completion may vary between 12-24 months (**Appendix 2: Course completion plan**).

Program Mission

The mission of the MPPD (RDN track) is to advance the practice of dietetic professionals for leadership roles in diverse settings, to promote human health and well-being, and improve quality of life.

SECTION II: MPPD POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

This section of the handbook highlights the policies specific to the MPPD relating to student admission, post admission policies and conduct while in the MPPD.

A. Admission Related Policies

Program Eligibility

Applicants must possess

- a bachelor's degree **and**
- completed a dietetic internship (DI) or a coordinated program in dietetics (CPD) **and**
- passed their national credentialing exam for Registered Dietitians (RDN) **and**
- maintained their registration status through continuing professional education credits utilizing the Commission on Dietetic Registration (CDR) portfolio.

Graduate Record Examination scores are not required.

Admission Requirements

The program application consists of the following:

- Demographic information. In addition to the name and contact information, applicants must also provide
 - CDR registration ID number (RDN number)
 - Intended start date: you can start in the spring, summer or fall semester
- Work experience
- Volunteer experience
- Leadership experience
- Personal statement (see expectations/requirements below)
- Two letters of recommendation, one of which should be a letter of support from employer, if currently employed (see expectations/requirements below)
- Application fee
- Attachment's
 - CDR card or certificate attesting date of passing the national registration exam
 - Current portfolio approval letter from CDR

A personal statement in (750 words or less) is also required and must include the following:

- Your reasons for applying to the MPPD.
- What skills you would like to gain in the program.
- What personal qualities will allow you to be successful in this online program.
- Your long and short-term goals.
- Your strengths and weakness.
- Please include any additional information that would help us evaluate your professional and leadership potential, or any extenuating circumstances of which the committee should be aware.

Two letters of recommendation from current or past work supervisors or those who can

attest to the applicant's ability to succeed in an online program are required. A letter of support from the current employer is recommended if one of the letters of recommendation is not from the current supervisor. Letters of recommendation from family or friends are discouraged.

Applicants are assessed for their ability to be successful in this distance, graduate program. A rubric is utilized to evaluate each applicant's academic performance, work and volunteer experiences, leadership qualities, representation of personal qualities and skills, and letters of recommendation. Admission information can be found on our website in the [admission and application portal](#).

B. Application Procedures

Students will apply to the MPPD via the [Graduate college application portal](#). Acceptance or rejection of the MPPD admission offer must be made in the Graduate College portal. Information about the Graduate College application can be found on the [Office of Admissions website](#).

C. Policies Post Acceptance to the MPPD

Program Orientation

Students who are accepted into the MPPD are required to complete a mandatory online program orientation in Canvas our learning management system. The program orientation course which is called the "Welcome and Resource Course", is asynchronous, and self-paced to provide you with essential information for your success in completing the MPPD. Deadlines for completion of orientation-related tasks are provided. Students will have access to the Welcome and Resource course, throughout the program.

Registration for Classes

You will register for classes in Workday. Please make sure you have completed the [onboarding requirements for Workday](#) as a new student. [Workday student resources](#) can be found on the Graduate College website. A schedule of MPPD courses can be found in **Appendix 1**.

Identity Verification for Distance Education

Applicants are issued a unique university ID number upon completion of the electronic graduate school application. Before students can access the university computer systems, they are required to set up a NetID and password. ISU graduate students may have their previous netID activated upon matriculation in Workday. Some prior ISU graduates may need to reapply for their netID and would be prompted to create one. ISU has multi-factor identification logins to verify that the person signing into the ISU electronic systems is valid. Only those students enrolled in the MPPD have access to the Canvas courses, which can be accessed via the student's unique ISU NetID and password. MPPD students are enrolled in relevant didactic courses in Canvas at the start of each semester (**Appendix 1** MPPD course schedule).

Protection of Privacy of Student Information

Students' personal files are stored electronically in the protected ISU electronic servers. Student identity is verified via use of ISU NetID and multi-factor authentication. Only those students enrolled in the MPPD have access to the program specific Canvas courses via their unique ISU NetID and password. Each student is enrolled into the specific MPPD didactic courses in Canvas at the start of each semester (**Appendix 1** MPPD course schedule).

Student Access to Their Own Student Files

Students' access to their personal files is covered by [ISU Registrar policies](#) which state that the students have the right to review upon request any records that pertain directly to them, and may obtain a copy of the record for a fee. This provision does not apply to records to which the student has waived their right to review, nor does it apply to medical and counseling records. MPPD policies are FERPA compliant.

Access to Student Support Services

Regardless of geographic location, all MPPD students, are considered ISU graduate students and thus have access to all student support services including but not limited to health services, counseling, testing, and financial aid.

- [Dean of Students Office](#)
- [Office of Student Financial Aid](#)
- [Thielen Student Health Center](#)
- [Academic Success Center](#)

ISU resources can be found at <https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/resources/>. Any fees related to the service is paid by the student.

Monitoring Student Performance

Students must maintain academic integrity and comply with the dietetics code of ethics in didactic courses to reflect the values and ethical principles that guide the profession of dietetics. The code of ethics can be found in **Appendix 3**.

Students in didactic courses must earn a grade of B- or better in all courses regardless of overall GPA per Department of Food Science and Human Nutrition policy and maintain a cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher in all coursework per Iowa State University Graduate College policy ([5.2.6. Probation and Academic Standing](#)). Students will be placed on academic probation if they do not maintain a cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher in all coursework. Students on academic probation are given one semester to improve their grades to 3.0 (on a 4.0 scale). These students will receive a warning letter from the Graduate College, which will be placed in the student's permanent file. Course faculty may provide feedback to the student based on the outcome of formative assessments and give the student the opportunity for remedial work and to resubmit assignments.

Regular Reports of Student Performance and Progress

The MPPD students are evaluated in a variety of ways such as quizzes, class discussions, case studies, capstone projects, and final exams. Students can expect to

receive feedback from faculty throughout the MPPD. All formal and/or informal feedback should be viewed as positive opportunities for continued growth. Students must maintain a minimum B- average in all courses and are graded according to the following scale:

- A: >93%
- A-: 90-93%
- B+: 87-89%
- B: 83-86%
- **B-: 80-82%**
- C+: 77-79%
- C: 73-76%
- C-: 70-72%
- < 70% not acceptable

Formative assessments will be used to identify student learning gaps and to help shape student learning in the program. These may include discussions, peer review, homework assignments etc. Summative assessments will be conducted to assess student performance via exams, final projects, etc. It is the student's responsibility to be familiar with the assessment format, timing, and evaluation criteria. University policy dictates that the program faculty shall inform the students at the beginning of each course of the evaluation procedures planned for use in the respective course. Additional university policy information related to grading, evaluation and record keeping is found at this website: <http://catalog.iastate.edu/>

Program Retention and Remediation Procedures

Per Iowa State University Graduate College policy ([5.2.6. Probation and Academic Standing](#)), students may be placed on academic probation if they do not maintain a cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher in all coursework. Students on academic probation are given one semester to improve their grades to 3.0 (on a 4.0 scale). These students will receive a warning letter from the Graduate College, which will be placed in the student's permanent file. Additionally, in accordance with the Department of Food Science and Human Nutrition policy, graduate students must earn a grade of B- or better in all courses regardless of overall GPA. **Only one repetition of any single course is permitted.** In addition, no more than four different courses used for graduate credit may be repeated over the course of the program. If the student is unable to meet the rigors of the program after appropriate remediation, then they may be terminated from the MPPD.

Disciplinary/Termination Procedures

The student may be disciplined or terminated for reasons including but not limited to: unsatisfactory academic performance (GPA of <3.0 in all coursework), inappropriate and/or criminal behaviors (such as academic dishonesty, plagiarism, verbally or physically threatening or harassing faculty, staff or fellow students, bringing any type of weapons to the ISU campus, etc.), violating the ISU code of conduct (<https://www.studentconduct.dso.iastate.edu/resources>) and/or breach of Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics code of ethics (**Appendix 3**).

Students have the right to appeal a dismissal for these reasons under the ISU Academic Grievance procedures (located at the ISU [Dean of Students website](#)).

Withdrawal and Refund of Tuition and Fees

Withdrawal from the program and refund of tuition and fees is regulated through ISU policies. Information regarding withdrawal and refund of tuition and fees are available on the ISU [Registrar's website](#).

Graduation and/or Program Completion Requirements

Successful completion of all didactic coursework results in a MPPD degree from ISU. Graduation/program completion requirement include the following:

1. **Didactic Requirements:** Students must maintain a cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher (on a 4.0 scale) in all coursework (ISU Graduate College policy ([5.2.6. Probation and Academic Standing](#))) AND earn a grade of B- or better in all courses regardless of overall GPA (Department of Food Science and Human Nutrition policy).
2. **Demonstrate professionalism throughout the program.** The following are expectations of all MPPD students:
 - a. Students must comply with ISU [code of student conduct](#) and the code of ethics for the nutrition and dietetics profession (**Appendix 3**). Violation of the code of ethics or ISU code of conduct may lead to disciplinary action and depending upon the seriousness of the infraction, may include remediation leading up to termination from the program.
 - b. Professionalism is a critical component of a student's success in the MPPD and the dietetics profession. Professional behavior includes but is not limited to dependability, reliability, attitude, and communication.
 - **Dependability and Reliability:** Managing expectation is part of being a professional. Taking full responsibility for one's own actions is critical. Faculty and peers should be able to rely on the students to contribute fully, honestly, and in a timely fashion. This means turning in an assignment/project by the deadline, being respectful of other people's (faculty, staff, and other students) time. In addition, to following the code of ethics for the nutrition and dietetics profession and the ISU code of conduct, students in the MPPD are expected to
 - Abide by all the policies and procedures of the MPPD outlined in this handbook.
 - complete required readings and assignments by the stipulated deadlines. Any illness or other extenuating circumstances that impede your ability to complete the assignments or the entire course by the stipulated deadlines, must be communicated with each course faculty in a timely manner.
 - complete course assessments, quizzes, exams case studies independently and on their own; unless assigned as a group activity.

- earn a minimum grade of B- in all courses and maintain a minimum cumulative grade point average of 3.0 (out of 4.0).
- **Communication:** Timely, polite, and honest communication is a hallmark of professionalism. Oral communication may include phone, virtual or face-to-face conversations. Written communication includes email, text and/or professional projects and assignments.
 - Canvas and ISU email are used for communication in the MPPD.
 - Students are required to check their email daily and respond within the requested time frame or within 24 hours from receipt of the email/written communication if a time frame is not specified.
 - Be polite, courteous, speak clearly, and listen when communicating orally.
 - Do not be in a hurry to respond. Thoroughly review and edit written communication before submitting/sending (this might include using a spell checker and/or Grammarly®) and observe e-mail etiquette.
 - Students must acknowledge and give due credit to work that is not their own. Plagiarism is a violation of the [ISU student code of conduct](#) and the code of ethics for the profession of nutrition and dietetics.
 - Students should contact their assigned clinical faculty promptly if they have questions or concerns related to the program.

The program director may terminate your participation in the program if:

1. you engage in actions endangering yourself or others;
2. your conduct is detrimental or incompatible with the best interest and welfare of the program;
3. despite remediation, your work and level of academic performance is below acceptable levels (See **Program Retention and Remediation Procedures** on page 9).

D. Academic and Program Calendar

Program schedule and holidays

The MPPD follows the academic calendar established by the Office of the Registrar
<https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/calendar>.

MPPD program timeline

The program can be completed in 12 months or 3 semesters. However, if you choose to complete it at a slower pace you may complete the program in 24 months.

Graduate College Resources for filing required paperwork

1. [Master's coursework only requirements](#)
2. [Master's coursework only graduation deadlines](#).

Onboarding	Register for classes in Workday
First semester	- Submit Committee Membership in Workday - Register for next semester classes in Workday
Second semester	- The Academic Plan must be approved no later than the end of the second term - Register for next semester classes in Workday
Third semester	Register for next semester classes in Workday, and refer to the Academic Plan and other Graduate College Deadlines on page 15
Fourth Semester	Register for next semester classes in Workday, and refer to the Academic Plan and other Graduate College Deadlines on page 15
Fifth Semester	Register for next semester classes in Workday, and refer to the Academic Plan and other Graduate College Deadlines on page 15
Sixth Semester	Submit Apply for program completion (no later than 2nd week of last semester) Coursework final check (check graduation deadline for submission deadline)

E. Tuition, Fees, and Program Expenses

MPPD students are eligible for any applicable financial aid and/or loan deferment. For more information, see the [ISU Office of Financial Aid website](#).

All students are charged instate tuition and fees which are noted below and are subject to change without notice. The applicants/students are encouraged to visit the Office of the Registrar: [Distance Education Tuition and Mandatory Fees](#) for current tuition and fees information.

Information specific to withdrawal from the MPPD program and refund of fees follows the university tuition adjustment policy: <http://www.registrar.iastate.edu/fees/tuition-adj>.

Program Related Expenses

No stipends are available in the MPPD and the student should plan for the following expenses

Full-Time Application Costs		
Item	Explanation	Cost
Application fee	Application fee to the ISU Graduate College	\$60
Program Costs		
ISU Graduate Tuition and Fees \$ 11544-12292	Spring Semester Tuition (\$748/credit)	\$4609.50
	Tuition for 6 credits*: \$4488	
	#Technology fees: \$121.50	
	Summer Semester Tuition (\$748/credit)	\$3861.5-4609.5

	Tuition for 5-6 credits*: \$3740-\$4488 #Technology fees: \$121.50	
	Fall Semester Tuition (\$748/credit)	\$3073
	Tuition for 4 credits*: \$2992 #Technology fees: \$81	
Supportive material	Computer (you are NOT required to purchase a new computer for the program; cost estimate provided in case you need to upgrade your technology)	\$1300
	Textbooks	\$250

**Tuition and fees are subject to change without notice.*

#Technology fee is charged to all Iowa State students regardless of on- or off-campus designation. This fee is used to support the computer infrastructure within the university.

Source: ISU [Tuition](#)

SECTION III: IOWA STATE UNIVERSITY POLICIES AND RESOURCES

This section of the handbook provides key Iowa State University policies and Graduate College resources and policies.

Iowa State University Resources

Resource	Contact Information
Dean of Students Office	dso@iastate.edu 515-294-1020
Iowa State Online	iowastateonline@iastate.edu 515-294-3916
The Office of the Registrar	registrar@iastate.edu 515-294-1840
Office of International Students and Scholars	isso@iastate.edu 515-294-1120
Student Counseling Services	cyclonehealth@iastate.edu 515-294-5802
Thielen Student Health Center	cyclonehealth@iastate.edu 515-294-5802
Office of Financial Aid	financialaid@iastate.edu 515-294-2223
Academic Success Center	success@iastate.edu 515-294-6624
University Library	circdesk@iastate.edu 515-294-3642

Iowa State University Policies

Nondiscrimination Policy

ISU strives to maintain our campus as a place of work and study for faculty, staff, and students that is free of all forms of prohibited discrimination and harassment based upon race, ethnicity, sex (including sexual assault), pregnancy, color, religion, national origin, physical or mental disability, age, marital status, sexual orientation, gender identity, genetic information, or status as a U.S. veteran. Any student who has concerns about such behavior should contact his/her instructor, Student Assistance at 515-294-1020 or email sas.dso@iastate.edu, or the Office of Equal Opportunity at 515-294-7612.

Student Privacy and Record Information

See the ISU Registrar's webpage for information related to the protection of privacy of student information and access to personal files:

<http://www.registrar.iastate.edu/policies>. Student education records are protected under the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA).

Name and Sex Marker Change Policies

Name and sex marker change must be processed through the Office of the Registrar. Additional information and forms can be found at <https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/resources/policies/name-and-sex-marker-change-policies>.

Special Accommodations

ISU complies with the American with Disabilities Act and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act. Eligible students must submit a request for Notification Letters from [Student Accessibility Services](#) through an online database called Accommodate each semester to receive accommodations. If students prefer to meet with a coordinator to receive Notification Letters, an individual appointment can be scheduled by calling the Student Accessibility Office at 515-294-7220 prior to the start of the program. *No retroactive accommodations will be provided.*

Graduate College Resources

A link to the Graduate College website and several key resources are provided below:
[Graduate College](#)
[Graduate College Handbook](#)
[Graduate College events](#)
[Master's coursework only requirements](#)
[Master's coursework only graduation deadlines.](#)
[Graduate College forms](#)

Academic Plan and Other Graduate College Deadlines

The scheduled courses of the MPPD (**Appendix 1**) serve as the student's Academic plan. The MPPD program director serves as the Major Professor for all students in the MPPD. As per the ISU Graduate College policy, no additional committee members are required for coursework-only programs like the MPPD. Detailed information for Master's coursework-only requirements including term-specific dates can be found on the ISU Graduate College website at <https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/masters-coursework-only-requirements>. Students will complete and submit the following required documentation in Workday in the sequence listed by the due dates.

1. **Committee membership** must be completed and approved before the other documentation listed below can be completed.
2. The **Academic Plan** must be approved no later than the end of the second term.
3. **Applying for program completion** must be completed no later than the second week of your last semester.
 - a. Any **incomplete grades** from the previous two semesters must be resolved no later than three weeks prior to graduation.
4. **Coursework Only Final Check** submission deadline can be found at [Master's coursework only graduation deadlines.](#)

Grades

Graduate students are required to maintain a cumulative 3.00 grade point average (GPA) in all courses. Failure to maintain a minimum cumulative 3.00 GPA will result in

the student being placed on academic probation by the Dean of the Graduate College. Details of the Graduate school grading policy can be found here:
<https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/handbook/chapter.php?id=5#5.2>

Grades for Graduate students

Grade	Points	Performance Description
A	4	Superior
A-	3.67	
B+	3.33	
B	3.00	Satisfactory
B-	2.67	
C+	2.33	
C	2.00	Minimum grade acceptable for courses on the POS
C-	1.67	Not used on the POS.
D+	1.33	Not used on the POS.
D	1.00	Not used on the POS.
D-	0.67	Lowest passing grade in courses, not used on POS.
F	0.00	Not satisfactorily completed, not allowed on the POS, but included in the GPA.
I		If a student is unable to complete the course work by the end of the term for reasons that the instructor thinks are legitimate, a mark of I (Incomplete) may be assigned because a grade has not yet been earned.
S		Satisfactory completion (figured in total hours earned but not in the GPA).
P		Passing grade under the P/NP system (figured in total hours earned but not in the GPA).
NP		Not passed under the P/NP system (not counted in total hours earned but not in the GPA). Typically must be repeated.
T		Test out with credit obtained by special examination.
X		Course dropped after first week of the semester.

Withdrawal

Before withdrawing from the MPPD, the student should discuss options with the MPPD program director. Information about withdrawing from the university and the MPPD, time of withdrawal in the semester and its impact on tuition levied can be found on the ISU Office of the Registrar's website (<https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/students/withdrawal>)

SECTION IV: APPENDICES

1. Master of Professional Practice in Dietetics Course Schedule.....	18
2. Course Completion plan.....	20
3. Code of Ethics for the Nutrition and Dietetics Profession.....	22
4. Consent to Use Work	26

IOWA STATE UNIVERSITY

Master of Professional Practice in Dietetics

Appendix 1

Course #		Credits
	Transfer credits	
GRST 5000	Graduate Transfer Credit	15
	Spring semester courses	
FSHN 5180	Advanced Nutrition II	3
FSHN 5380	Advanced Medical Nutrition Therapy	3
	Summer semester courses	
FSHN 5370	Leadership and Management in Dietetics	3
FSHN 5080	Consumer Perceptions and Nutrition Communication	2
	Fall semester courses	
FSHN 5160	Advanced Nutrition I	2
FSHN 5330	Diet and Integrative Therapies for Prevention and Treatment of Disease	2
	Total Credits	30

All courses are required and must be taken in the semester offered. FSHN 5180 can be taken before FSHN 5160.

Course descriptions

Course #	Course title	Cr	Course Description	Semester Offered
GR ST 5000	Graduate Transfer Credit	15	CDR Education Credit	All
FS HN 5180	Advanced Nutrition II	3	Principles of research design/methods and interpreting results/statistics in the current peer-reviewed scientific literature. Critical evaluation of the evidence-base to inform advanced professional nutrition practice.	Spring
FS HN 5380	Advanced Medical Nutrition Therapy	3	Nutritional biochemistry and physiology related to selected pathophysiology of disease with emphasis on treatment of complex medical problems. The nutrition care process will be utilized. Evidenced-based practice will be integrated into each disease state covered.	Spring
FS HN 5080	Consumer Perceptions and Nutrition Communication	2	Examination of current consumer food and nutrition trends. Critical analysis of consumer perceptions relative to current research base. Use of various media (New Courses release/story, infographic, print/publication, and YouTube video) to create effective nutrition messages for consumers.	Summer
FS HN 5370	Leadership and Management in Dietetics	3	Application of leadership and management theories and approaches relevant to dietetics practice. Use of self-reflection and self-assessment to assist in recognition and development of leadership behaviors	Summer
FS HN 5160	Advanced Nutrition I	2	Advanced nutrition delves into the intricate relationship between dietary intake and overall health, focusing on the molecular and cellular mechanisms that underlie nutrient absorption, metabolism, and use.	Fall
FS HN 5330	Diet and Integrative Therapies for Prevention and Treatment of Disease	2	Explore the role of specific nutrients, dietary bioactive compounds and integrative therapies on foods, drugs, disease prevention and treatment.	Fall

IOWA STATE UNIVERSITY

Master of Professional Practice in Dietetics

RDN Track Course Completion Plan

Name:

Anticipated Graduation Date:

Using the course list on the next page, indicate which course(s) you plan to take each semester.

Semester 1:			Semester 2:		
Course #	Credits	Sem/Yr	Course #	Credits	Sem/Yr

Semester 3:			Semester 4:		
Course #	Credits	Sem/Yr	Course #	Credits	Sem/Yr

Semester 5:			Semester 6:		
Course #	Credits	Sem/Yr	Course #	Credits	Sem/Yr

All courses are required and must be taken in the semester offered.

FSHN 5180 can be taken before FSHN 5160.

Course #	Course title	Cr	Course Description	Semester Offered
GR ST 5000	Graduate Transfer Credit	15	CDR Education Credit	
FS HN 5180	Advanced Nutrition II	3	Principles of research design/methods and interpreting results/statistics in the current peer-reviewed scientific literature. Critical evaluation of the evidence-base to inform advanced professional nutrition practice.	Spring
FS HN 5380	Advanced Medical Nutrition Therapy	3	Nutritional biochemistry and physiology related to selected pathophysiology of disease with emphasis on treatment of complex medical problems. The nutrition care process will be utilized. Evidenced-based practice will be integrated into each disease state covered.	Spring
FS HN 5080	Consumer Perceptions and Nutrition Communication	2	Examination of current consumer food and nutrition trends. Critical analysis of consumer perceptions relative to current research base. Use of various media (New Courses release/story, infographic, print/publication, and YouTube video) to create effective nutrition messages for consumers.	Summer
FS HN 5370	Leadership and Management in Dietetics	3	Application of leadership and management theories and approaches relevant to dietetics practice. Use of self-reflection and self-assessment to assist in recognition and development of leadership behaviors	Summer
FS HN 5160	Advanced Nutrition I	2	Advanced nutrition delves into the intricate relationship between dietary intake and overall health, focusing on the molecular and cellular mechanisms that underlie nutrient absorption, metabolism, and use.	Fall
FS HN 5330	Diet and Integrative Therapies for Prevention and Treatment of Disease	2	Explore the role of specific nutrients, dietary bioactive compounds and integrative therapies on foods, drugs, disease prevention and treatment.	Fall

Code of Ethics for the Nutrition and Dietetics Profession

Effective Date: June 1, 2018

Preamble:

When providing services the nutrition and dietetics practitioner adheres to the core values of customer focus, integrity, innovation, social responsibility, and diversity. Science-based decisions, derived from the best available research and evidence, are the underpinnings of ethical conduct and practice.

This Code applies to nutrition and dietetics practitioners who act in a wide variety of capacities, provides general principles and specific ethical standards for situations frequently encountered in daily practice. The primary goal is the protection of the individuals, groups, organizations, communities, or populations with whom the practitioner works and interacts.

The nutrition and dietetics practitioner supports and promotes high standards of professional practice, accepting the obligation to protect clients, the public and the profession; upholds the Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics (Academy) and its credentialing agency the Commission on Dietetic Registration (CDR) Code of Ethics for the Nutrition and Dietetics Profession; and shall report perceived violations of the Code through established processes.

The Academy/CDR Code of Ethics for the Nutrition and Dietetics Profession establishes the principles and ethical standards that underlie the nutrition and dietetics practitioner's roles and conduct. All individuals to whom the Code applies are referred to as "nutrition and dietetics practitioners". By accepting membership in the Academy and/or accepting and maintaining CDR credentials, all nutrition and dietetics practitioners agree to abide by the Code.

Principles and Standards:

1. Competence and professional development in practice (Non-maleficence)

Nutrition and dietetics practitioners shall:

- a. Practice using an evidence-based approach within areas of competence, continuously develop and enhance expertise, and recognize limitations.
- b. Demonstrate in depth scientific knowledge of food, human nutrition and behavior.
- c. Assess the validity and applicability of scientific evidence without personal bias.
- d. Interpret, apply, participate in and/or generate research to enhance practice, innovation, and discovery.
- e. Make evidence-based practice decisions, taking into account the unique values and circumstances of the patient/client and community, in combination with the practitioner's expertise and judgment.
- f. Recognize and exercise professional judgment within the limits of individual qualifications and collaborate with others, seek counsel, and make referrals as appropriate.
- g. Act in a caring and respectful manner, mindful of individual differences, cultural, and ethnic diversity.
- h. Practice within the limits of their scope and collaborate with the inter-professional team.

2. Integrity in personal and organizational behaviors and practices (Autonomy)

Nutrition and dietetics practitioners shall:

- a. Disclose any conflicts of interest, including any financial interests in products or services that are recommended. Refrain from accepting gifts or services which potentially influence or which may give the appearance of influencing professional judgment.
- b. Comply with all applicable laws and regulations, including obtaining/maintaining a state license or certification if engaged in practice governed by nutrition and dietetics statutes.
- c. Maintain and appropriately use credentials.
- d. Respect intellectual property rights, including citation and recognition of the ideas and work of others, regardless of the medium (e.g. written, oral, electronic).
- e. Provide accurate and truthful information in all communications.
- f. Report inappropriate behavior or treatment of a patient/client by another nutrition and dietetics practitioner or other professionals.
- g. Document, code and bill to most accurately reflect the character and extent of delivered services.
- h. Respect patient/client's autonomy. Safeguard patient/client confidentiality according to current regulations and laws.
- i. Implement appropriate measures to protect personal health information using appropriate techniques (e.g., encryption).

3. Professionalism (Beneficence)

Nutrition and dietetics practitioners shall:

- a. Participate in and contribute to decisions that affect the well-being of patients/clients.

- b. Respect the values, rights, knowledge, and skills of colleagues and other professionals.
- c. Demonstrate respect, constructive dialogue, civility and professionalism in all communications, including social media.
- d. Refrain from communicating false, fraudulent, deceptive, misleading, disparaging or unfair statements or claims.
- e. Uphold professional boundaries and refrain from romantic relationships with any patients/clients, surrogates, supervisees, or students.
- f. Refrain from verbal/physical/emotional/sexual harassment.
- g. Provide objective evaluations of performance for employees, coworkers, and students and candidates for employment, professional association memberships, awards, or scholarships, making all reasonable efforts to avoid bias in the professional evaluation of others.
- h. Communicate at an appropriate level to promote health literacy.
- i. Contribute to the advancement and competence of others, including colleagues, students, and the public.

4. Social responsibility for local, regional, national, global nutrition and well-being (Justice)

Nutrition and dietetics practitioners shall:

- a. Collaborate with others to reduce health disparities and protect human rights.
- b. Promote fairness and objectivity with fair and equitable treatment.
- c. Contribute time and expertise to activities that promote respect, integrity, and competence of the profession.
- d. Promote the unique role of nutrition and dietetics practitioners.
- e. Engage in service that benefits the community and to enhance the public's trust in the profession.
- f. Seek leadership opportunities in professional, community, and service organizations to enhance health and nutritional status while protecting the public.

Glossary of Terms:

Autonomy: ensures a patient, client, or professional has the capacity and self-determination to engage in individual decision-making specific to personal health or practice.¹

Beneficence: encompasses taking positive steps to benefit others, which includes balancing benefit and risk.¹

Competence: a principle of professional practice, identifying the ability of the provider to administer safe and reliable services on a consistent basis.²

Conflict(s) of Interest(s): defined as a personal or financial interest or a duty to another party which may prevent a person from acting in the best interests of the intended beneficiary, including simultaneous membership on boards with potentially conflicting interests related to the profession, members or the public.²

Customer: any client, patient, resident, participant, student, consumer, individual/person, group, population, or organization to which the nutrition and dietetics practitioner provides service.³

Diversity: "The Academy values and respects the diverse viewpoints and individual differences of all people. The Academy's mission and vision are most effectively realized through the promotion of a diverse membership that reflects cultural, ethnic, gender, racial, religious, sexual orientation, socioeconomic, geographical, political, educational, experiential and philosophical characteristics of the public it serves. The Academy actively identifies and offers opportunities to individuals with varied skills, talents, abilities, ideas, disabilities, backgrounds and practice expertise."⁴

Evidence-based Practice: Evidence-based practice is an approach to health care wherein health practitioners use the best evidence possible, i.e., the most appropriate information available, to make decisions for individuals, groups and populations. Evidence-based practice values, enhances and builds on clinical expertise, knowledge of disease mechanisms, and pathophysiology. It involves complex and conscientious decision-making based not only on the available evidence but also on client characteristics, situations, and preferences. It recognizes that health care is individualized and ever changing and involves uncertainties and probabilities. Evidence-based practice incorporates successful strategies that improve client outcomes and are derived from various sources of evidence including research, national guidelines, policies, consensus statements, systematic analysis of clinical experience, quality improvement data, specialized knowledge and skills of experts.²

Justice (social justice): supports fair, equitable, and appropriate treatment for individuals¹ and fair allocation of resources.

Non-Maleficence: is the intent to not inflict harm.¹

References:

1. Fornari A. Approaches to ethical decision-making. *J Acad Nutr Diet.* 2015;115(1):119-121.
2. Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics Definition of Terms List. June, 2017 (Approved by Definition of Terms Workgroup Quality Management Committee May 16, 2017). Accessed October 11, 2017. <http://www.eatrightpro.org/~media/eatrightpro%20files/practice/scope%20standards%20of%20practice/academydefinitionoftermslist.ashx>
3. Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics: Revised 2017 Standards of Practice in Nutrition Care and Standards of Professional Performance for Registered Dietitian Nutritionists. *J Acad Nutr Diet.* 2018; 118: 132-140.
4. Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics "Diversity Philosophy Statement" (adopted by the House of Delegates and Board of Directors in 1995).

Master of Professional Practice in Dietetics

Consent Form for Use of Master of Professional Practice in Dietetics (MPP) Work in Reporting and Assessment Activities

I, _____, consent to the use of my Iowa State University MPP work for outcomes assessment, accreditation reporting purposes, and program evaluation research to improve the quality of the program, such as online performance evaluations. I understand that any data gathered from my work as a student will be kept confidential so that no individual could be identified. I understand that this work may be shown to internal and external evaluators as examples of student work in the MPP curricula.

☐ Yes, I give my consent to use my work.

Student Signature: _____

Date: _____

☐ **No, I do not** give my consent to use my work.

Student Signature: _____

Date: _____